Jaya Harsha Thippana

Principal Data Scientist | AI, experimentation & team leadership

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PROFILE

Data science leader connecting scientific judgment, team building and production delivery. Lead R&D and Data Science at Vizit, reporting to the CEO and leading five data scientists. Experience spans visual AI, causal inference, randomized experimentation, production ML and customer-facing science.

SELECTED IMPACT

$35M	$15M+	75%
Annualized revenue Harley-Davidson	Annual savings Northwestern Mutual retention	Less decision time Northwestern Mutual claims

Reported career outcomes from three separate initiatives; figures are not combined.

EXPERIENCE

Vizit

Apr 2025 - Present | Boston, MA

Principal Data Scientist

- Promoted from Senior Data Scientist (Apr 2025) to Staff (Sep 2025) and Principal (Mar 2026).
- Lead scientific direction, hiring, mentorship and delivery across R&D and Data Science; report directly to the CEO.
- Connect visual-AI research, model evaluation and product priorities. Partner with product and engineering to carry scientific decisions into production.
- Used randomized controlled trials during evaluation of a scoring change to understand its impact and build rollout confidence.
- Applied difference-in-differences and experiment design to customer impact studies; delivered 60 studies and automated 5,000+ analyst hours through self-serve analysis.
- Present and defend scientific methodology with enterprise customers, making assumptions and limitations understandable.

Northwestern Mutual

Dec 2021 - Apr 2025 | Boston, MA

Senior Data Scientist

- Shipped a production disability-claims ML pipeline that reduced decision time by 75%.
- Built financial-representative churn prediction associated with $15M+ in annual savings; a separate initiative from claims automation.
- Worked on language-model extraction from handwritten claims forms and reusable modeling methods; managed junior analysts and data scientists.

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RESUME / CONTINUED

EXPERIENCE / CONTINUED

Harley-Davidson Motor Company

Aug 2019 - Dec 2021 | Milwaukee, WI

Data Scientist

- First data science hire; helped build the function and led data scientists and analysts reporting insights to executives.
- Built prospect-identification models associated with $35M in annualized revenue.
- Developed customer intelligence covering lifetime value, sentiment, customer journeys, and lead and retention scores; partnered with marketing and product teams.

University of Oklahoma

Mar 2018 - Jun 2019 | Oklahoma

Data Scientist (Intern to Data Scientist)

- Researched deep-learning classification of breast masses in digital mammograms, including preprocessing, validation and interpretability.
- Built Python data pipelines and classification models for gray-market device detection. Graduate teaching assistant for Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining.

Pyro Group

Jun 2016 - Jul 2017 | Hyderabad, India

Java Developer

- Developed dynamic web applications in an agile team; received the Best Employee award for design and development.

TECHNICAL & LEADERSHIP STRENGTHS

Research & evaluation: Causal inference, randomized controlled trials, A/B testing, difference-in-differences, experiment design, computer vision, representation learning, NLP, generative AI and imbalanced learning.

Engineering: Python, SQL, XGBoost, ONNX, production ML pipelines, AWS, Snowflake, model deployment and monitoring, reusable Python packages.

Leadership: Scientific strategy, hiring and mentorship, team building, executive communication, customer-facing science and cross-functional product delivery.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

M.S. Computer Science - University of Oklahoma
B.Tech Computer Science - Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University

English, Hindi and Telugu.